ADVANCE
FRONT AND CENTRE

19 January 2026

Mr Jerome Laxale MP
Chair
Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters
PO Box 6021
Parliament House
Canberra ACT 2600

Via email: em@aph.gov.au

Dear Mr Laxale

Re: Correction of False Statements Regarding ADVANCE

We refer to the Public Hearing of the Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters held in Parramatta on Thursday, 20 November 2025.

According to the Proof Hansard of the Hearing, Dr Ryan, Member for Kooyong, made the following false claims regarding ADVANCE –

> *"**Dr RYAN**: … Morgan Jonas is publicly a representative of the Freedom Party, and we know that the Freedom Party—and this is a matter of public record—received funding from ADVANCE during the 2025 election. …"*
>
> *"**Dr RYAN**: It's clear that the Liberal Party has been funding in 2025. The Liberal Party has funded third party organisations to, effectively, campaign on its behalf. Those are organisations like ADVANCE and organisations like the Freedom Party. …"*

The claims that ADVANCE has provided funding to the Freedom Party and that ADVANCE has received funding from the Liberal Party are simply lies, and an affront to our now more than 600,000 grassroots supporters across the country.

Dr Ryan claims that it "is a matter of public record" that the Freedom Party was funded by ADVANCE. A simple check by us shows that the Freedom Party is not a Federally registered party, it is only registered in Victoria and lodged annual returns with the Victorian Electoral Commission. These returns do not show any support from ADVANCE for the simple reason that it did not happen.

Dr Ryan further claims that it is 'clear' that the Liberal Party has funded 'organisations like ADVANCE', but once again a simple check of the Australian Electoral Commission records show that this is not the case.

It is also noted that ADVANCE has only received one donation from the Cormack Foundation in 2023-24. Our 2024-25 Annual Return has been lodged with the Australian Electoral Commission

and will confirm that no donations have been received during that period from the Cormack Foundation or the Liberal Party.

We have written separately to Dr Ryan seeking a public apology and retraction of these false claims. On behalf of our supporters across the nation, and in the interests of transparency and accountability, we are asking the Committee to ensure that our rebuttal of these claims, and any retraction from Dr Ryan, is included with the Hansard record of the Hearing.

Yours faithfully

[redacted]

Matthew Sheahan
Executive Director